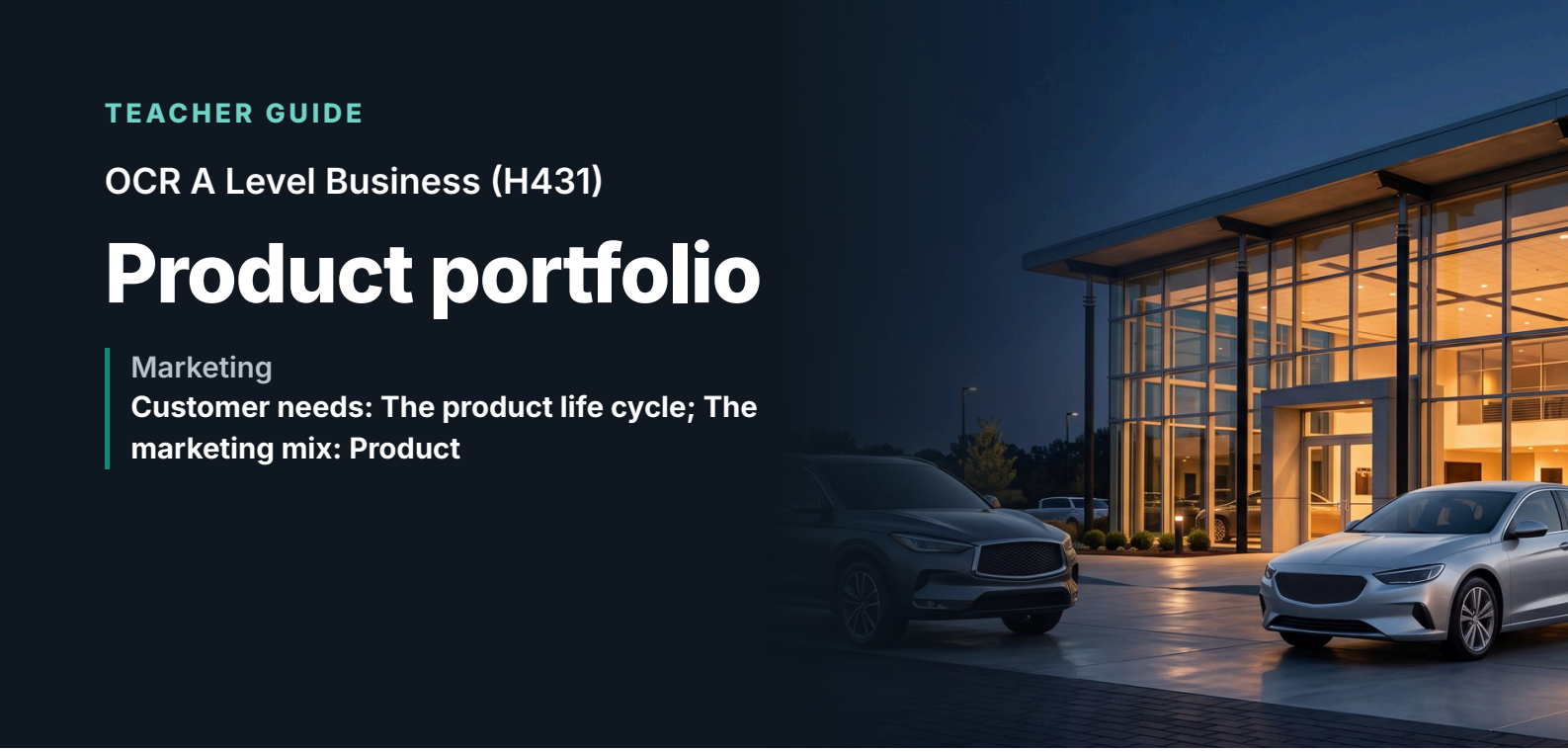
TEACHER GUIDE

OCR A Level Business (H431)

Product portfolio

Marketing
Customer needs: The product life cycle; The marketing mix: Product



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise product portfolio on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	45 min	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

1 Boston category

Round 1

Your newest model has 5% of a market growing 20% a year. The leader has 40%.

Which Boston matrix category is this?

- **A** Question mark
- **B** Dog
- **C** Cash cow
- **D** Star

ANSWER

✓ Question mark

Why: A low share of a high-growth market is a question mark, not a star.

2 A balanced range

Round 1

You want a balanced range of models.

Which two should the range include?

- **A** Only models with a small share
- **B** One model for every buyer
- **C** Models in growing markets
- **D** Only models in shrinking markets
- **E** Models that bring in steady cash

ANSWER

✓ Models in growing markets
✓ Models that bring in steady cash

Why: Steady earners pay for the models that will earn in future.

3 Rank market growth

Round 2

Three of your models and their markets, sales last year and this year.

Order by market growth, fastest first?

- **A** 40,000 to 40,800 cars
- **B** 10,000 to 11,000 cars
- **C** 5,000 to 6,000 cars

ANSWER

1. 5,000 to 6,000 cars
2. 10,000 to 11,000 cars
3. 40,000 to 40,800 cars

Why: Growth: 20%, 10%, 2%.

Topic tasks

4 Growth and share

Round 2

Your model in its market.

Market growth, and your share this year?

Market sales last year	**40000 cars**
Market sales this year	**50000 cars**
Your model's sales this year	**2000 cars**

ANSWER

25% growth, 4% sh

(50,000 − 40,000) ÷ 40,000 = 25%; 2,000 ÷ 50,000 = 4%

Why: Growth compares with last year; share is of this year's market.

5 Where cash goes

Round 3

Your leader in a slow market makes spare cash. A newer model has a small share of a fast market.

Where should the spare cash go, and why?

A The newer model in the fast market

B Back into the leader that earned it

ANSWER

✓ The newer model in the fast market

Why: Cash from a mature leader is best spent building the next winner.

6 Risk in the range

Round 3

Your range: a cash cow in a shrinking market, two dogs, and no stars or question marks.

What is the main risk to the firm?

A Negative cash flow today

B Nothing to replace the cash cow

C Too many models in growing markets

D Stars use up too much cash

ANSWER

✓ Nothing to replace the cash cow

Why: With no stars or question marks, nothing will replace the cash cow when it fades.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on product portfolio. They come from these 8 questions.

Then each pupil writes one short answer: “Evaluate whether your firm should drop a loss-making model.”

1 Research shows range anxiety is the main barrier to a used-EV launch. Which campaign response is most coherent?

✔ **Show verified battery health and real ranges**

2 A premium campaign promises a two-hour turnaround, but work usually takes four hours. Strongest conclusion?

✔ **The promise is not credible yet**

3 A model’s sales have levelled off, most target customers know it, and rivals offer close alternatives. Which life cycle response is most coherent?

✔ **Defend profitable segments, refresh differentiation or plan replacement on evidence**

4 A small dealer cannot match a platform’s scale but has trusted expertise in wheelchair-accessible vehicles. Most defensible position?

✔ **Focus on the specialist niche**

5 A dealer has strong electric-vehicle expertise but weak capital reserves. Which strategic choice best uses the evidence?

✔ **A focused EV service niche at small scale**

6 A dealer group’s used-EV line has a small share of a fast-growing market. In the Boston Matrix, what is it?

✔ **Question mark**

7 Sales of a model grow fast and rivals begin to copy it. Which stage of the product life cycle is this?

✔ **Growth**

8 A model’s sales have levelled off. Which action is an extension strategy?

✔ **Launching a hybrid version**